

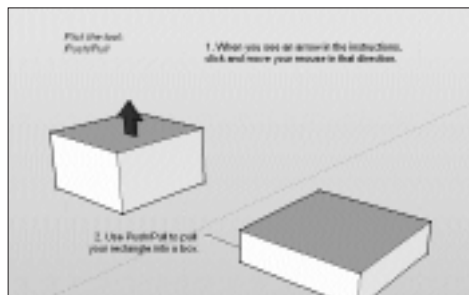
niques that go into creating 3D models. Go to http://download.sketchup.com/OnlineDoc/gsu_win/GoogleSketchUpHelp.htm (or <http://snipurl.com/googsketch>) and go through the Concepts section to get a basic understanding on what is involved in 3D modelling. Alternately, download the complete user guide from http://download.sketchup.com/GSU/pdfs/GSUUsersGuide_WIN.pdf (or <http://snipurl.com/googsketch1>) and read the concepts from page 9 of the PDF document.

Once you've understood the concepts, you can take the self-paced tutorials to familiarise yourself with the tools and controls you will use to create and manipulate 3D models. If you are

running SketchUp for the first time, you will be prompted to take the tutorials through the Tip of the Day dialog box. You can also access the tutorials from **Help > Self-Paced Tutorials**. This three-part tutorial gives you a solid grounding in using and working with 3D objects in SketchUp.

You can then go on to video tutorials (<http://sketchup.google.com/tutorials.html>) that will show you how to work with SketchUp, introduce you to the SketchUp 3D Warehouse, and show you how to place the 3D models in Google Earth. Additionally, you can print the Quick Reference card (<http://download.sketchup.com/GSU/pdfs/QuickReferenceCard.pdf>, or <http://snipurl.com/googsketch2>) and keep it within easy reach and access it when working with SketchUp.

Once you begin working with SketchUp, help is at hand: just open the “Instructor” window. This will show you information



Go through the tutorials as slow as you need

about the tool you've currently selected. Enable the Instructor window from the menu (**Window > Instructor**). Also, whenever you work with a tool, don't hesitate to right-click and explore the options that pop up with whatever object you are pointing at. There is no faster way to learn than using the software itself.

You can also join the Google Groups SketchUp community (<http://groups.google.com/group/sketchup>) and get further help and support other newbies as they begin to use SketchUp. Also check out the Wiki for “The Ultimate Encyclopedia for Everything SketchUp”—www.suwiki.org. It has tons of information, tutorials, tools, tips and tricks and more!

12.3 Components

Components are pre-built objects that are included with SketchUp and available for download. These help in speeding up creation of your 3D objects, as you do not have to create them from scratch. You can explore the components that came along with SketchUp by going to the installation folder and opening the Components sub-folder (usually **C:\Program Files\Google\Google SketchUp\Components\Sampler**). Use **File > Open** to open the included components. You can also download component sets (<http://sketchup.google.com/components.html>) pre-built for specific industries such as Architecture, Construction, and Film & Stage.

12.4 3D Warehouse & Google Earth

The 3D Warehouse is an online catalogue of 3D models that you can search and download. You can also create your own 3D models and share them through the warehouse. Access the 3D Warehouse directly



Browse through 3D models in the 3D warehouse